The Omnipresent eye of today's world

tion as they tend to have more and better features than their low-resolution brethren. They produce pictures big enough to print at up to A4 in size; that is plenty for a mobile snap. However, jumping up to 8 megapixels or 10 megapixels can increase digital "noise" without visibly improving detail.

Autofocusing is an absolute must. Look out for a macro mode for really sharp close-ups. Some camera phones come with all manner of specialist scene modes. More useful are easy, one-touch overrides such as exposure compensation for highlights or shadows, and spot-focusing to concentrate on your main subject.

Camera phones are notorious for taking extremely poor pictures in low light conditions due to the weak nature of the LED flashes that they use. Recently, however, new technologies have emerged that produce superior low light performance without compromising on the camera phone's battery. One such technology that one must look for in mobile cameras is Xenon flash. A proper xenon flash, like the ones found on dedicated cameras, will punch out enough photons to light up an entire room. It gives off an extremely strong burst of light, typically up to several hundred thousand lux but has an extremely short duration, of the order of 50-100 microsec-